

Personal Blog - Project Documentation

Project Overview

A full-stack personal blogging platform where I can document my experiences, technology learnings, recommendations, and thoughts.

The platform consists of:

- Public-facing blog website
- Secure admin dashboard
- Backend API
- MongoDB database

The primary objective of the MVP is to provide a smooth publishing workflow for a single author.

MVP Goals

The MVP should allow me to:

- Log into the admin dashboard
- Create blog posts
- Save posts as drafts
- Publish posts
- Edit existing posts
- Delete posts
- Upload cover images
- Organize posts by category
- Search published posts
- Read posts on a responsive public website

The website should immediately reflect newly published content without requiring redeployment.

Out of Scope (MVP)

The following features are intentionally postponed:

- Multiple users
- Comments
- Newsletter
- RSS Feed
- Analytics
- AI-assisted writing
- Timeline view
- Travel map

- Notifications
 - Likes
 - Bookmarks
 - Social login
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Technology Stack

Frontend

- React
 - Vite
 - React Router DOM
 - Tailwind CSS v3.4.x
 - Axios
 - Lucide React
 - React Hot Toast
 - Tiptap Editor
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Backend

- Node.js
 - Express.js
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Database

- MongoDB Atlas
 - Mongoose
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Authentication

- JWT
 - HTTP-only Cookies
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Image Storage

- Cloudinary
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Deployment

Public Blog

- Vercel

Admin Dashboard

- Vercel

Backend API

- Render

Source Control

- GitHub
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Repository Structure

```
PersonalBlog/  
  
apps/  
  blog/  
  admin/  
  api/  
  
docs/  
  
assets/  
  
.gitignore  
package.json  
README.md
```

Project Structure Philosophy

- One GitHub repository
 - Independent applications
 - Shared documentation
 - Feature-driven development
 - Small, verifiable milestones
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Content Categories

The blog will initially support the following categories:

- Journal
- Technology
- Recommendations
- Places
- Life

Additional categories can be introduced after the MVP.

Theme Strategy

Dark mode will **not** be implemented during the initial UI development.

Implementation plan:

- Build all pages in Light Mode
- Complete responsive layouts
- Add Dark Mode across the application after the UI stabilizes

Dark mode implementation:

- Tailwind CSS `class` strategy
 - Theme stored in localStorage
 - Respect system preference on first visit
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Development Workflow

Every feature follows the same process:

1. Plan
2. Implement
3. Test
4. Verify
5. Commit
6. Proceed to the next feature

No new feature begins until the current one is working correctly.

Git Strategy

Main branch:

- `main`

Feature branches:

- `feature/<feature-name>`

Example:

- `feature/authentication`
- `feature/post-editor`
- `feature/blog-home`

Every completed milestone should be committed before starting the next.

Code Style Principles

- Keep components small and focused.
 - Avoid premature optimization.
 - Prefer readability over clever code.
 - Keep business logic out of UI components where possible.
 - Reuse components when appropriate.
 - Follow consistent naming conventions.
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MVP Success Criteria

The MVP is complete when:

- The admin panel is accessible through authentication.
 - Posts can be created, edited, deleted, drafted, and published.
 - Images can be uploaded.
 - The public website displays published posts.
 - Categories and search work correctly.
 - The application is responsive.
 - The project is deployed successfully.
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Future Roadmap

Version 1.1

- Tags

- Reading time
- Related posts
- SEO improvements

Version 1.2

- Recommendation module
- Photo gallery
- Place pages

Version 1.3

- Timeline
- Archives
- Better search

Version 2

- Comments
- Newsletter
- Analytics
- RSS Feed
- PWA
- "On This Day" memories
- AI-assisted writing

Guiding Principle

Build a reliable publishing platform first. Add enhancements only after the core writing and publishing experience is complete.